

Missions to the Moon

The first spacecraft to reach the Moon was the Soviet (Russian) probe Luna 2, which deliberately smashed into the Moon's surface in 1959. Since then there have been dozens of missions to the Moon, both manned and unmanned.

Successful missions

Many missions to the Moon have failed due to technical reasons. The chart below lists the dates of some of the missions that have been successful together with the type of spacecraft used for each mission.

Serial no.	Name	Launch year	Place of origin	Type of spacecraft
1	Pioneer 4	1959	US	Flyby
2	Luna 2	1959	USSR/Russia	Lander
3	Luna 3	1959	USSR/Russia	Flyby
4	Ranger 7	1964	US	Lander
5	Ranger 9	1965	US	Lander
6	Zond 3	1965	USSR/Russia	Flyby
7	Luna 9	1966	USSR/Russia	Lander
8	Luna 10	1966	USSR/Russia	Orbiter
9	Surveyor 1	1966	US	Lander
10	Lunar Orbiter 1	1966	US	Orbiter
11	Lunar Orbiter 2	1966	US	Orbiter
12	Lunar Orbiter 4	1967	US	Orbiter
13	Explorer 35	1967	US	Orbiter
14	Lunar Orbiter 5	1967	US	Orbiter
15	Surveyor 7	1968	US	Lander
16	Luna 14	1968	USSR/Russia	Orbiter
17	Zond 6	1968	USSR/Russia	Flyby
18	Apollo 8	1968	US	Orbiter
19	Apollo 10	1969	US	Orbiter
20	Apollo 11	1969	US	Lander
21	Luna 16	1970	USSR/Russia	Lander
22	Luna 17/Lunokhod 1	1970	USSR/Russia	Lander
23	Apollo 15	1971	US	Lander
24	Apollo 17	1972	US	Lander
25	Luna 21/Lunokhod 2	1973	USSR/Russia	Lander
26	Hiten (MUSES-A)	1990	Japan	Orbiter/Lander
27	Clementine	1994	US	Orbiter
28	SMART-1	2003	Europe	Orbiter
29	Kaguya (SELENE)	2007	Japan	Orbiter
30	Chang'e 1	2007	China	Orbiter/Lander
31	Chandrayaan 1	2008	India	Orbiter/Lander
32	Lunar Reconnaissance Orbiter	2009	US	Orbiter
33	Chang'e 2	2010	China	Orbiter
34	GRAIL (Ebb and Flow)	2011	US	Orbiter
35	Chang'e 3/YUTU	2013	China	Lander
36	Manfred Memorial Moon Mission	2014	Luxembourg	Flyby